

JOSHUA PRETTYMAN, PHD

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RE: Data Scientist role at Verif

Dear hiring team,

I am writing to apply for the Data Scientist position on Verif's Fraud Engineering team. With over eight years of experience spanning production ML systems and applied research, I am drawn to the challenge of building detection systems that stay ahead of evolving threats.

At Blink SEO, I built a full-stack ML platform from the ground up—architecting a Python back-end on GCP Compute Engine integrated with BigQuery to process over 50 million data points daily. I developed NLP-powered clustering models, created asynchronous job-queue systems in PostgreSQL, and deployed interactive dashboards that transformed how the team worked. This experience gave me a strong foundation in taking models from prototype to production at scale.

My PhD research at the National Physical Laboratory focused on detecting tipping points in complex systems—identifying early warning signals before critical transitions occur. While the domain was geophysical rather than fraud, the core challenge is analogous: recognising subtle patterns in noisy, high-dimensional data that precede significant events. This work sharpened my ability to develop novel detection strategies and validate hypotheses rigorously.

I bring proficiency in Python, SQL, and the ML stack you've outlined (scikit-learn, Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib), along with practical experience deploying models in cloud environments. I'm comfortable communicating technical findings to diverse stakeholders, having published in peer-reviewed journals and presented at international conferences.

I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to Verif's next-generation fraud detection platform and help establish trust online.

Thank you for considering my application.

Yours faithfully,

Joshua Prettyman